

you, and you may be able to whittle it down even further based on your due diligence.

DID YOU KNOW?

No matter which plan you purchase, preventive services are now free to all health care subscribers as a result of Obamacare. This includes yearly checkups and screenings.

3. TAKE ADVANTAGE OF FREE OR LOW-COST SERVICES

If you don't have health insurance, or come up short on cash, there are free or low-cost health clinics around the country that offer services to patients regardless of their ability to pay.

- NAFCclinics.org allows you to search for clinics near your zip code.
- For free breast exams and cervical screenings, you can find a local program through the CDC or Komen.org/Affiliates. These programs usually allow at least one checkup per year.
- Stop by Walgreens or CVS for common conditions such as strep throat, pink eye, and ear infections, just to name a few. These clinics offer lower costs outside a regular doctor's visit, and list a price sheet right on their websites so you know exactly what you have to pay.

Even a general Google search for “free or low-cost health care clinic” along with your state will pull up a variety of options so you can get the care you need, at a price you can afford.

4. PHONE IT IN

Whether you have an excessive allergy problem, weird rash, or pain, call your doctor before making the trek to see if they can help you over the